sustain the expensive military–industrial complex of the developed countries. Thus, the North–South dialogues between the developed countries and the LDCs for the establishment of the NIEO, have proved to be “little more than hollow mockery”.

The LDCs have alleged that the failure to realize the NIEO is due to the lack of commitment and lack of their ‘political will’. The Havana Summit Conference of 1979 of the non-aligned states, comprising an overwhelming number of LDCs noted that even after five years of adoption of the NIEO and the Charter of Economic Rights and Duties of States, there has been no structural change in the international economic scenario and it “continues its pervasive deterioration aggravated and accelerated by the effects of the world economic crisis”. It also took into account “the intransigency of most of the developed countries and their refusal to engage in serious negotiations to implement the above-mentioned resolutions which have prevented the fundamental restructuring of economic relations included in the basic objectives of the New International Economic Order”.[19]

Scholars also point out the failure of the LDCs to realize NIEO primarily due to the South’s lack of power in world politics, and partly because disparities within the South created divergent interests among the member states. Also it became apparent that many of the proposed commodity schemes were not simply a proposal for stable prices, but, high prices. As such, the financial costs of implementing these programmes were way beyond anything the advanced countries were willing to fund. In the 1980s, the terms of trade further deteriorated for the raw material exporters, and the debt problems of many of the nations advocating the NIEO in international forums surpassed all limits.

Under the chairmanship of the former West German Chancellor, Willy Brandt, the Independent Commission on International Development Issues examined the problems being faced by the global economy in the early 1980s. Brandt’s panel of former world leaders and other prominent figures found that developing nations were economically dependent on developed nations, which dominated the international rules and institutions for trade, money